

Criterion E: Evaluation



Criterion E (4 marks) is your final reflection. Here, you must critically evaluate your product against the specific success criteria you defined in Criterion A, using evidence from your testing in Criterion D. You must also propose and justify specific, actionable improvements for the future, moving beyond simple fixes to show a deeper understanding of your product's limitations and potential.

Criterion E: Evaluation

This is the final section of your IA documentation, where you reflect on your project's success and its future.

Goal: To critically evaluate your final product against your original goals and suggest meaningful improvements.

Recommended Word Count: ~400 words

Part 1: Evaluating the Success Criteria

This is the core of your evaluation. You must go back to your list of **8-10 success criteria from Criterion A** and evaluate the extent to which each one was met.

- You must be honest and critical. If a feature doesn't work perfectly, this is where you discuss it.
- You must **refer to evidence from Criterion D and your video** to support your evaluation.

Tool for the Job: The Evaluation Table

The clearest way to present this is in a table.

Success Criterion (from A)	Fully Met? (Yes/Partially/No)	Evidence (from Criterion D / Video)
SC-01: "The solution will allow for the input, editing, and deletion of all customer records."	Yes	"This is demonstrated in the video (Time 0:30-1:15) and confirmed by test cases T-02 and T-05 in Criterion D."

SC-02: "The solution will warn users about invalid data (e.g., letters in a 'quantity' field)."	Yes	"This is shown in the video at 1:20 and confirmed by test case T-01. The correct error message was displayed."
SC-03: "The solution will allow the user to sort the inventory alphabetically."	Partially	"The sorting feature works, as shown in the video (1:45). However, testing revealed that it is case-sensitive (e.g., 'Zebra' comes before 'apple'). Therefore, this criterion is only partially met."

Part 2: Justifying Improvements

Based on your evaluation (and any "Fails" or "Partiallys"), you must suggest **specific and actionable improvements** for the future. You must *justify* these improvements by explaining *how* they would address the issues you identified.

Good vs. Bad Improvements

This is a key area where students lose marks. Your suggestions must be meaningful, not just simple fixes. The Teacher Support Material (p. 75) gives clear examples of what *not* to do.

Bad Improvements (Vague / Inadequate)	Good Improvements (Specific / Justified)
"Make it more user-friendly."	"The UI could be improved by replacing the text-based menu with a graphical user interface (GUI), which would make the product more accessible to the target user (the librarian)."
"Add more colours."	"To address the partially-met SC-03, I would refactor the sorting algorithm to convert all strings to lowercase before comparison, ensuring a true alphabetical sort."
"Add more features."	"A key limitation is the single-user login. A future improvement would be to add a user-privilege system (e.g., 'Admin' vs. 'Student' accounts) to enhance security."
"Add a payment function." (This is a <i>missing</i> feature, not an <i>improvement</i> .)	"Based on test case T-04 (which failed), the program crashes with large numbers. I would improve this by changing the 'quantity' variable from a 16-bit integer to a 32-bit long integer to prevent the overflow error."

